

Bonang N. Seoela

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REFERENCES	Volodymyr Lugovskyy, Ph.D. Professor and Department Chair Indiana University Bloomington vlugovsk@iu.edu Paul Graf, Ph.D. Professor Indiana University Bloomington paulgraf@iu.edu	Ahmad Lashkaripour, Ph.D. Associate Professor Indiana University Bloomington alashkar@iu.edu Craig Shaul Labor Market Research Manager Idaho Department of Labor Craig.Shaul@labor.idaho.gov
EDUCATION	Indiana University Bloomington, Bloomington, IN Ph.D. in Economics Aug 2022 – May 2027 (expected) Boise State University, Boise, ID M.S. in Economics Aug 2018 – May 2020 The College of Idaho, Caldwell, ID B.S. in Mathematics and Physics; Minor in Business Aug 2014 – May 2018	
RESEARCH AND TEACHING FIELDS	Primary research fields: International Trade; Environmental and Energy Economics. Secondary research fields: Spatial Economics; Labor Economics; Computational Macroeconomics. Teaching fields: International Economics; Microeconomics; Environmental and Energy Economics; Public Policy Analysis.	
JOB MARKET PAPER	“Environmental Regulation, Firm Export Dynamics, and Welfare: Evidence from Mexico’s Air-Quality Programs” (Link to most recent version) Air quality regulations often target pollution where exposure is highest, creating spatial differences in both compliance costs and environmental benefits. This paper studies one such intervention, Mexico’s ProAire air-quality programs, and their effects on manufacturing emissions, firm trade, and consumer welfare. I combine the staggered rollout of ProAire across municipalities from 2011 to 2020 with linked firm-level data. I first show that the decline in Mexican manufacturing emissions intensity between 2005 and 2018 was driven mainly by within-industry technique changes, which account for 88 percent of the reduction. After ProAire adoption, reported CO₂ emissions among RETC-reporting firms fall by 11 percent. Trade adjustment occurs primarily through the extensive and intensive margins of exporting. Export entry changes little, export exit rises by 2.8 percentage points, and export sales among continuing exporters fall by 9.5 percent, while imports among continuing importers rise by 18 percent. I then evaluate the welfare implications of spatially targeted regulation through a quantitative spatial model with heterogeneous firms, pollution-intensive production, international trade, atmospheric transport, and worker sorting. I find that ProAire lowers output by 0.07 percent, while welfare rises by 0.099 percent.	
JOURNAL PUBLICATION	1. Seoela, Bonang N. (2022). “Efficacy of monetary policy in a currency union? Evidence from Southern Africa’s Common Monetary Area.” <i>Quantitative Finance and Economics</i>, 6(1), 35–53. DOI.	
WORKING PAPERS	1. “Energy Price Shocks along the Global Supply Chain: The Effects of Fossil Fuel Reforms in Mexico” <i>Draft in progress</i> 2. “Does Minimum Wage Increase Formal Employment? Tax Incentives and Informality at Mexico’s Northern Border” <i>Draft in progress</i> 3. <i>Disrupted Routes, Missing Relationships: Transport Shocks and Firm-to-Firm Trade</i> 4. <i>Impact of Air Quality Regulations on Entrepreneurial Activity</i> (with Samia Islam, 2020).	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Indiana University Bloomington, Department of Economics - Associate Instructor (<i>full teaching responsibility</i>), ECON 303 Survey of International Economics Fall 2024; Spring 2026	

	- Teaching Assistant, ECON-B 251 Principles of Microeconomics Fall 2023; Spring 2024; Fall 2025	
	Boise State University , Department of Economics	
	- Teaching Assistant, ECON 303 Intermediate Microeconomics Spring 2020 - Teaching Assistant, ECON 511 Advanced Microeconomic Theory I Fall 2019 - Teaching Assistant, ECON 455 Behavioral Economics Fall 2019	
PROFESSIONAL AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Congressional Budget Office Washington, DC	
	<i>Associate Analyst Intern</i> May 2024 – Aug 2024	
	• Analyzed borrower- and loan-level data on modifications in federal housing programs to support microsimulation estimates of subsidy rates and federal budget costs; prepared analytical summaries and presentations for senior analysts.	
	Idaho Department of Labor Twin Falls, ID	
	<i>Labor Economist</i> Aug 2020 – Jul 2022	
	• Conducted econometric and spatial analysis of employment, wages, labor-force participation, housing, and regional industry trends; designed surveys and translated results into public reports and stakeholder briefings. • Main project used a Spatial Durbin Model to study home-price dynamics across 49 Idaho cities over 2011–2020; findings were featured on the front page of the <i>Idaho Business Review</i>.	
	Boise State University Boise, ID	
	<i>Graduate Research Assistant</i> Aug 2018 – May 2020	
	• Supported faculty research through data collection, cleaning, econometric analysis, literature reviews, and manuscript drafting using R and Stata.	
	Albertsons Companies Boise, ID	
	<i>Data Science Intern</i> May 2019 – Nov 2019	
	• Cleaned, merged, and validated sales and inventory datasets exceeding 50 million observations and supported predictive modeling and statistical analysis.	
	Second Wave Capital Management Remote	
	<i>Financial Analyst Intern</i> Aug 2017 – Dec 2017	
	• Supported acquisition due diligence, valuation analysis, market research, and preparation of investment materials for senior management.	
FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS AND HONORS	Witney/LeMar Fellowship, Indiana University Spring 2026	
	Tobias Center Research Support Grant, Indiana University Fall 2025	
	Berkeley/Sloan Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics Aug 2025	
	Best Graduate Student Paper, Indiana University Spring 2025	
	Southern Region Educational Board Doctoral Scholar, Indiana University 2022 – 2027	
	John J. and Ethel C. Chapman Graduate Economics Fellowship 2019 – 2020	
	Economics Department Signature Student, Boise State University Fall 2019	
POLICY BRIEFS AND MEDIA	Selected policy reports	
	1. “Why are home prices across Idaho Cities rising faster than the national average?” IDOL, 2022. Link .	
	2. “Idaho’s center of population continues westward shift.” IDOL, 2022. Link .	
	3. “Idaho beef industry showing marked recovery.” IDOL, 2021. Link .	
	4. “A closer look at Idaho’s financial activities sector in the past decade: A shift-share analysis.” IDOL, 2020. Link .	
	In the Media	
	“Dept. of Labor report: Idaho needs more entry-level homes,” <i>Idaho Business Review</i> , August 2022. Link .	
TECHNICAL SKILLS	Programming and software: Python, R, Stata, SQL, MATLAB, EViews, and LaTeX; Tableau and Power BI.	
	Methods: staggered difference-in-differences; quantitative spatial general equilibrium; spatial econometrics; panel ARDL; structural VAR; supervised machine learning.	
CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS	Tobias Center Research Symposium (2026); BREAD Conference on Development Economics (2026); AIER Classical Liberalism and The Market Seminar (2026); UC Berkeley Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics (2025); Hoosier Economics Conference (2025)	
PERSONAL INFORMATION	Dual citizen of the United States and Lesotho.	
	Hobbies: Road and trail biking, soccer, and tennis.	